

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Russia targets Ukraine energy grid

Kyiv denied access to satellite images US previously supplied

By Illia Novikov and Jon Gambrell
Associated Press

KYIV, Ukraine — Russia attacked Ukrainian energy facilities with dozens of missiles and drones during the night, officials

said Friday, hobbling the country's ability to deliver heat and light to its citizens and to power weapons factories vital to its defenses.

The overnight barrage — which also pounded residences and wounded at least 10 people — came days after the U.S. suspended military aid and intelligence to Ukraine to pressure it into accepting a peace deal being pushed by the Trump administration. Without U.S. intelligence, Ukraine's ability

to strike inside Russia and defend itself from bombardment is significantly diminished.

The U.S. government said Friday it halted Ukrainian access to unclassified satellite images that had been used to help it fight back against Russia.

Meanwhile, President Donald Trump said Friday that he is “strongly considering” levying new sanctions and tariffs on Russia for its war against Ukraine, floating

the possibility of new pressure on Moscow.

Trump, in a post on his Truth Social platform, said he was considering the action “based on the fact that Russia is absolutely ‘pounding’ Ukraine on the battlefield right now.”

He added that the prospective sanctions could remain in place until the two sides come to a cease-fire and peace settlement.

The sanctions threat came as

Trump faces criticism for increasing pressure on Ukraine to reach a deal while playing down or even denying Russia's responsibility for starting the war with its invasion three years ago.

“To Russia and Ukraine, get to the table right now, before it is too late,” Trump added in his post.

Later, when asked by a reporter during an Oval Office exchange if

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SBA cites sanctuary policy in closure

Small business agency says it will relocate Chicago regional office

By Talia Soglin
Chicago Tribune

The U.S. Small Business Administration will close its regional office in Chicago and move it out of the city because of its immigrant-friendly policies, the agency said Thursday. However, the agency does not appear to have any plans to move or close its district office in the city, which provides direct services to local small-business owners.

Confusion began swirling Thursday when the agency announced it would relocate six regional offices throughout the country because they are in cities that “do not comply with U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement.”

“Over the coming months, the Atlanta, Boston, Chicago, Denver, New York City and Seattle regional offices will be moved to less costly, more accessible locations that better serve the small business community and comply with federal immigration law,” the SBA said in a statement.

The SBA did not mention any plans to close or move any district offices, including in Chicago, but the announcement still raised alarm in some corners, an example of the often chaotic approach of the administration of President Donald Trump regarding the operations of federal agencies, leaving the agencies and their employees mired in confusion.

The SBA's Chicago regional office, which serves as a sort of headquarters for the agency's field operations throughout the Great Lakes region, is at 332 S. Michigan Ave.

But the agency also operates a

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Two top Illinois officials leaving posts

Departures of Alicia Tate-Nadeau, the state's disaster response director, and Sanjay Gupta, secretary of the Department of Innovation & Technology, were announced Friday.

Chicagoland, Page 3

Musk, Rubio clash at Cabinet meeting

At the White House, Elon Musk chastised Secretary of State Marco Rubio for firing “nobody,” leading to a prolonged argument and President Donald Trump coming to Rubio's defense.

Nation & World

Blackhawks trade Mrázek, Smith

Team sends goaltender Petr Mrázek and forward Craig Smith to the Red Wings and acquires forward Joe Veleno before the trade deadline.

Chicago Sports



ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Catching snowflakes and the bus

A student catches snowflakes as classmates line up next to a school bus during a field trip on South Michigan Avenue in Chicago on Friday. Friday's snow will give way to mostly sunny skies with a high of 50 on Saturday.



Cubs coach Jerry Weinstein walks on the field before a Cactus League game against the White Sox at Sloan Park in Mesa, Ariz., on Feb. 22

ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Love of baseball, teaching fuels 1st-year Cubs coach — at age 81

Weinstein pushes players, and himself, to continue to grow

By Meghan Montemurro
Chicago Tribune

MESA, Ariz. — A pitch-dark sky greets Jerry Weinstein every morning when he arrives at the Chicago Cubs spring training complex.

The 81-year-old coach is known for being the first among the staff to arrive each day, typically pulling up around 4:30 or 5 a.m.

“He’s done working out

before the rest get there,” bench coach Ryan Flaherty said with a laugh.

By the time staff and players arrive for morning workouts, Weinstein already has posted multiple tweets with videos and commentary, often highlighting catching and baserunning techniques and drills, to his 89,700 followers on X — all part of a spring routine that belies his age.

Weinstein wasn’t much of a social media guy until about 11 years ago, when his book, “The Complete Handbook of Coaching Catchers,” was published and he was told he should have

an online presence. Initially he shared snippets from the book, but over the years he has expanded to posting a few things a day, touching on a variety of baseball topics.

“It’s about the high sea floats all the boats,” Weinstein told the Tribune. “The better we can make the game on the amateur level, the better those players are going to be as an entry-level college player or professional player.”

“A lot of people helped me along the way. It’s payback time, and I like sharing.”

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Chicago Heights crematory shut down

State oversight begins after complaint over handling of remains

By Olivia Stevens
Daily Southtown

A Chicago Heights crematory has been shut down after the Illinois comptroller's office received a complaint last month of the facility mishandling human remains, according to the state agency.

Heights Crematory, 230 E. 11th St., faces penalties of up to \$5,000 for each violation found during the comptroller's office's ongoing investigation and could have its crematory license revoked. It is prohibited from taking on any new cases and is receiving help from the state to process about 100 bodies it had in storage.

“There were bodies sort of stacking up at this crematory,” said Abdon Pallasch, spokesman for the comptroller's office, declining to elaborate on conditions as their investigation continues.

Michael Sharkey, of the Illinois Funeral Directors Association, said Thursday his group forwarded a complaint they received of poor conditions at Heights Crematory to the comptroller's office Feb. 18, prompting the state investigation.

“We immediately, that very day, brought the complaint to the regu-

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